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Abstract Submission Form

Cedefop Call for papers: “Harnessing Artificial Intelligence and Digital Technologies for Inclusive and Resilient Vocational Education and Training (VET)”.

Fields marked with * are mandatory.

Building on Cedefop’s work on inclusion within the VET for youth teachers and trainers team, Cedefop is pleased to announce a call for papers for a special Working Paper series exploring how artificial intelligence (AI) and advanced digital technologies are being used in vocational education and training (VET) to promote inclusion, resilience, and sustainable transitions in the context of Industry 5.0.

The aim of this call is to address existing research gaps on the use of AI in VET to promote inclusion, in order to strengthen the evidence base needed for inclusive and future-oriented VET systems.
More information about the event may be found on the Call for papers (https://www.cedefop.europa.eu/files/cedefop_call_for_papers_2026_0.pdf).

Please submit your abstract by filling in and submitting the form below. The form should be filled in only once for your abstract (i.e., in case of multiple co-authors, only the main author is expected to fill in the form).

Key dates

- Deadline for submission of abstracts: **15 April 2026**
- Notification of acceptance: **30 April 2026**
- Deadline for submission of draft full papers of accepted abstracts: **31 July 2026**

- Deadline for submission of final full papers: **Three weeks following feedback from Cedefop**
- Notification of invitation to Cedefop event: **early 2027**
- Cedefop event: **June 2027 (tbc)**
- Publication in Cedefop special working paper series: **Spring 2027**

Abstract submission guidelines

- Abstract length: maximum 500 words
- Language: English
- Information included: title, author name(s), institutional affiliation(s), ORCID identifier(s) if relevant, and up to five keywords
- Assessment criteria: relevance to the call, originality, methodological rigour, clarity of presentation, and policy relevance for European VET

For questions related to the call: vet.toolkit@cedefop.europa.eu (mailto:vet.toolkit@cedefop.europa.eu)

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In case of more co-authors, kindly complete corresponding details (as above) below:

Abstract

*Abstract title

AI as Cognitive Infrastructure for Equity: How Generative AI Transforms Teaching Practice and Learning Outcomes in Vocational Education from Socioeconomically Disadvantaged Contexts

*Abstract (max 500 words)

Vocational education and training (VET) systems across Europe face a persistent equity challenge: teachers and learners from lower socioeconomic backgrounds and geographically isolated regions have systematically fewer resources for professional development, pedagogical innovation, and access to expert support networks. This structural disadvantage shapes not only what students learn, but how

teachers teach—limiting their capacity to design rigorous, learner-centred materials and methodologies. While research on AI in education has grown substantially, evidence on how generative AI tools function as equalising infrastructure for under-resourced VET practitioners remains scarce.

This paper presents a practitioner-led qualitative study examining how a VET teacher in Business Administration (Gestión Administrativa, EQF level 3-4) in an insular territory of Spain’s Balearic Islands systematically integrated generative AI into her professional practice over one academic year (2025-2026). Drawing on reflective practitioner methodology (Schön, 1983) and the capability approach (Sen, 1999), the study analyses three interconnected dimensions: (a) the teacher’s use of AI as a “cognitive colleague” for material design, methodological planning, and critical reflection—compensating for the absence of professional networks typically available in larger educational institutions; (b) the transfer effects on students, particularly those from disadvantaged backgrounds, who describe AI as “the private tutor I could never afford”; and (c) the systemic implications for VET policy when AI enables practitioners in peripheral contexts to produce outputs comparable to those of well-resourced urban centres.

Data sources include a documented portfolio of AI-assisted teaching materials produced during the academic year, structured reflective journals, qualitative observations of student engagement and learning outcomes, and testimonials from a parallel teacher training programme (35 VET teachers across seven centres in the Balearic Islands) where participants reported similar equity-enhancing effects of AI integration.

The study contributes to three gaps identified in this call. First, it provides empirical evidence on Theme 5 (teachers’ digital competence and professional practice) from a practitioner perspective rarely represented in academic literature—a teacher without doctoral credentials or institutional research support who nonetheless produces rigorous, theoretically grounded pedagogical innovation. Second, it addresses the inclusion and intersectionality lens by examining how socioeconomic origin and geographical isolation interact to create compounded disadvantage that AI can partially mitigate. Third, it offers policy-relevant insights on Theme 2 (learner-centred pedagogies), demonstrating how AI-assisted instructional design combined with peer-mediated learning creates zones of proximal development that are otherwise inaccessible to students and teachers in under-resourced VET settings.

The paper argues that AI in VET should be understood not merely as an instructional tool but as cognitive infrastructure for equity—for learners who lack private tutoring, for teachers who lack collegial networks, and for peripheral territories that lack institutional resources—a thesis with direct implications for European VET policy on digital transformation, teacher professional development, and inclusive education.

* Keywords

generative AI, vocational education and training, socioeconomic equity, zone of proximal development, inclusive digital transformation

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Following the submission of this form a confirmation pop-up message will appear on your screen, acknowledging the submission of your abstract.

A notification of acceptance will be sent until **30 April 2026.**

Thank you!

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